



FREE GUIDE · FOR ANIMAL SHELTERS & CONTROL

The Animal Shelter's Guide to Compliant Waste Disposal.

Euthanasia controls the DEA regulates — plus
sharps, meds, and biohazard, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Pentobarbital is a controlled substance.

Animal shelters and municipal animal control carry controlled euthanasia solutions — pentobarbital — that the DEA regulates exactly like human controlled substances, so unused and expired stock must be rendered non-retrievable with documentation. Add euthanasia and injection sharps, expired animal medications, and biohazard, and you have real regulated waste. This guide covers every stream. (Carcass disposal is handled separately — we cover the controlled substances, sharps, meds, and biohazard.)

The good news

One DEA-registered partner can destroy your euthanasia controls non-retrievable, with Form 41 and witnessed logs — plus sharps, expired meds, and biohazard, documented every time. No contract.

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

Euthanasia solutions and controlled drugs — your highest-scrutiny stream.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused pentobarbital & euthanasia solution
- Wasted & partial doses
- Surrendered controlled stock

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, witnessed logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled destruction to DEA standards, with documentation.

Tip

Log and witness every wasted controlled dose — the DEA checks the paper trail.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

Euthanasia, injection, and vaccine sharps.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Euthanasia & injection needles
- Vaccine sharps
- Syringes & lancets

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Non-sharp packaging

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line; keep them upright, closable, and out of reach.

WASTE STREAM 03

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired animal medications.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired non-controlled animal meds
- Discontinued medications
- Samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own path)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous and controlled drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Segregate hazardous and controlled drugs first — everything else routes here.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Blood and OPIM biohazard from procedures.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked materials & PPE
- Procedure biohazard
- Contaminated disposables

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Lightly soiled everyday items
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit or scheduled pickup.

Tip

Only visibly blood/OPIM-contaminated items are red-bag waste — check your state's definition.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The animal shelter compliance checklist.

- ☐ Euthanasia controls (pentobarbital) logged, witnessed, and rendered non-retrievable with Form 41.
- ☐ A defensible controlled-substance paper trail (the DEA regulates euthanasia drugs closely).
- ☐ Euthanasia and injection sharps in FDA-cleared containers.
- ☐ Expired animal medications destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Blood/OPIM biohazard red-bagged and destroyed.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per DEA and state rules.

QUESTIONS SHELTERS ASK

Your animal shelter questions, answered.

How do we dispose of expired euthanasia solution?

Pentobarbital is a DEA-controlled substance — render it non-retrievable with a Form 41 and witnessed logs, never trashed or flushed. We handle it just like any controlled substance.

Are euthanasia sharps handled specially?

They're sharps — in an FDA-cleared container and a sharps mail-back kit or pickup — but any residual controlled drug is documented and destroyed compliantly.

Do you handle carcass disposal?

No — that's a separate service. We cover your controlled substances, sharps, medications, and biohazard.

Do we need a contract?

No — no contract, no minimums.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle gives animal shelters DEA-compliant destruction of euthanasia controls — Form 41 and witnessed logs — plus sharps, expired meds, and biohazard, documented every time. No contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Euthanasia solution (pentobarbital)	Controlled destruction (Form 41, wasting logs)
Euthanasia & injection sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Expired animal meds	Pharmaceutical waste kit
Blood / OPIM biohazard	Biohazard kit or pickup

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Higher-volume or multi-facility operations may prefer scheduled pickup. We'll size it — get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY ANIMAL SHELTERS & CONTROL FACILITIES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your animal shelter waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop